

Wealth, once concentrated in metropolitan areas, is now far more dispersed. Banks go where customers are,” says Dave, whose bank also offers products for children’s foreign education, international investing, and starting a business overseas. There is also a GIFT City offering for global wealth products, investment banking, and corporate solutions.

attractive. “If customers use our card more, they have to settle payments with us, which keeps balances in the account. The same applies to wealth. When clients engage with us for investments, money flows through our accounts. We also have unique capabilities such as efficient Liberalised Remittance Scheme processing, including through GIFT City,” he says.

equity. Linked to HSBC’s global Innovation Banking network, it gives Indian start-ups access to capital, expertise, and international markets. “We back them because we believe in the business model, even when the market is not yet ready,” says Dave.

AI ADOPTION

HSBC India has been at the forefront of digital adoption across all major processes for retail, wholesale, and transaction banking business units. In fact, it has emerged as the best bank in the innovation category among foreign banks. The bank’s innovation is focussed on AI-driven customer insights and decisions, modernised digital channels (API-first, Cloud-ready), process re-engineering using automation and workflow digitisation across retail, wholesale, and transaction banking. For example, a mortgage processing pre-approval, which took two days, now gets complete in 45 minutes through digital documentation, automated property checks, etc. “It frees up our relationship managers to focus on higher-value work, and it reassures customers that they are dealing with a bank that is both knowledgeable and responsive,” says Dave.

“We are applying the same approach to FEMA, which generates the highest volume of queries, from both customers and internal teams. This creates significant value for our relationship managers as well as for customers, because the system now provides instant answers,” says Dave.

With a conservative balance sheet, disciplined expansion, and innovation, HSBC India is redefining what long-term foreign banking success in India looks like. **BT**

THE ELITE FIVE

● Best CASA growth in a competitive market ● Highest ROE, which matters for shareholders

RANK	BANKS	ASSETS	GROWTH IN CASA	NET NPAs	SECURED ASSETS	ROA
1	HSBC India	378,941	13.52%	0.03%	66.43%	1.83%
2	Deutsche Bank	167,292	3.16%	0.28%	56.95%	1.96%
3	JP Morgan Chase	186,602	13.98%	0.00%	18.22%	2.37%
4	Mizuho Bank	50,671	9.48%	0.00%	35.91%	1.68%
5	Bank of America	137,176	-2.09%	0.00%	15.40%	2.11%

NOTE FIGURES IN ₹ CRORE

SOURCE BT-KPMG SURVEY OF INDIA'S BEST BANKS & NBFCs

CASA ADVANTAGE

While additional branches can drive deposit growth, the bank is already gaining share in CASA deposits. It has clocked the second-highest growth in CASA at 13%. Within CASA, savings accounts have grown in double digits.

“We are very clear on one thing: banks that can grow low-cost liabilities will be the winners,” says Dave. He explains at the retail level, it can be as simple as making the credit card

On the corporate side, it is about being embedded in critical flows—salary processing, dividend payouts, EPFO payments. “We are the only international bank that can process EPFO payments end-to-end,” says Dave.

HSBC India has set up a dedicated division called “Innovation Banking”—a platform designed to support start-ups at every stage. The bank has set aside \$1 billion in non-dilutive debt, allowing founders to grow without giving up